CONCISE EDITION • 26 OCTOBER 2026 • 09:00 HKT

US equities slip as yields rise, energy leads gains

A 5-minute read of yesterday's US session and today's catalysts — what to watch before pre-market opens at 21:30 HKT.

2-3 page read · Topics: Macro · Geopolitics · Earnings

TL;DR

The S&P 500 fell -0.52% to 7,623.68, while the Dow dropped -1.23% to 52,215.16. The 10-year Treasury yield jumped +0.71% to 4.99%, pressuring growth stocks.

Energy rallied sharply; XLE surged +2.60% on higher crude prices, offsetting broader weakness. Investors await next-week earnings from the tech mega-caps.

US session recap

INDEX / ASSET	CLOSE	CHANGE	NOTE
S&P 500	7,623.68	-0.52%	
Dow Jones	52,215.16	-1.23%	
Nasdaq 100	28,957.53	-0.00%	
Russell 2000	2,775.90	-0.29%	
VIX	19.45	+2.21%	volatility up
10Y Yield	4.99%	+0.71%	peak since 2024
WTI Crude	101.09	-2.11%	

Top large-cap movers

TICKER	CLOSE	CHANGE
MSFT	524.51	+0.66%
XLK	183.23	+0.49%
XLE	69.33	+2.60%
NVDA	210.96	-0.59%

Spotlight

METRIC	VALUE
Event	U.S. CPI (Sep)
YoY	-0.3%
Core CPI	-0.2%
Implication	Inflation still above target, keeping Fed hawkish.

September CPI came in slightly below expectations but core inflation remains sticky, reinforcing the Fed’s reluctance to cut rates.

Macro & Fed

- Policy rate: 5.25% (unchanged)
- 10-year yield at 4.99%, up +0.71%
- Data releases (HKT): CPI 02:30, PPI 04:30, Existing-home sales 07:00

Geopolitics & global

- Middle-East tensions ease after cease-fire talks, reducing oil-supply risk.
- China’s export data due Friday; markets watching for signs of demand rebound.
- Eurozone manufacturing contraction deepens, pressuring the euro.

Earnings — what to watch

WHEN (HKT)	TICKER	WHAT TO LOOK FOR
02:00	`AAPL`	iPhone 17 demand, services margin
03:30	`NVDA`	AI chip orders, inventory levels
05:00	`META`	Ad revenue rebound, AI integration
06:30	`JPM`	Net interest income, loan growth

Stocks worth watching

- `TSLA` – price pressure from lower margins, but new battery tech pending.
- `XLE` – energy ETF gains on higher crude, could outpace broader market.
- `XLV` – defensive health care rally as risk-off sentiment rises.
- `AVGO` – semiconductor supply constraints may boost pricing power.
- `GS` – exposure to higher rates could lift earnings.

What could break the tape

BEARISH TRIGGERS

- Unexpected rise in CPI or PPI keeping rates high.
- Geopolitical escalation in the Middle East spiking oil.
- Weak earnings from the tech mega-caps.

BULLISH TRIGGERS

- Better-than-expected CPI core slowdown.
- Strong earnings surprise from `NVDA` or `AAPL`.
- Positive Chinese export data indicating global demand rebound.

Sources

SOURCES

Reuters — US Markets

Bloomberg — Economic Data

CNBC — Earnings Calendar

Financial Times — Energy

Wall Street Journal — Market Data